

1 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Mystery object bag

What we are practising

Practise naming objects and describing their uses.

What you need

Cloth bag / Large spoon / Small towel / Large toy car

Hide one object behind your back instead of using a bag.

Before you begin

Place three familiar, safe objects in the bag.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Describe the spoon: "We use this to eat soup."
2. Let your child guess, then show the object.
3. Invite your child to choose another object and give you a clue.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What else could you tell me without saying its name?

Space to explore

2 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

One-sentence story circle

What we are practising

Connect spoken ideas and listen to another speaker.

What you need

No materials

A favourite soft toy can be the story character.

Before you begin

Sit together and choose a familiar animal.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Begin: "A little cat found a hat."
2. Ask your child what the cat does next; repeat their idea in a sentence.
3. Add one sentence each, then finish with the cat returning home.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What happened after the cat tried on the hat?

Space to explore

3 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Animal sound detective

What we are practising

Associate familiar sounds with names and take speaking turns.

What you need

No materials

Point to familiar animal pictures if making sounds is uncomfortable.

Before you begin

Choose three animals your child already knows.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Make a gentle “meow” and ask which animal it could be.
2. Name the cat together and describe one feature, such as whiskers.
3. Let your child make a different sound for you to identify.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What clue helped you decide?

Space to explore

4 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 5 minutes

Where is Teddy?

What we are practising

Use and understand on, under and beside.

What you need

Soft toy / Cushion

Use a rolled pair of socks instead of a toy.

Before you begin

Put the cushion on the floor with space around it.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Put Teddy on the cushion and say “on”.
2. Ask the child to put Teddy under, then beside, the cushion.
3. Swap roles so your child tells you where Teddy should go.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Can you show me beside without covering Teddy?

Space to explore

5 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

My day in three pictures

What we are practising

Use first, next and last to describe an order.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Act out the three actions instead of drawing.

Before you begin

Draw a cup, toothbrush and shoes in three separate spaces.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Ask your child what each picture might mean.
2. Choose the order that matches your family's morning.
3. Point to each picture and tell the routine using first, next and last.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What do you usually do before putting on your shoes?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Mystery object bag

A little hint

Name an action: eating, drying or rolling.

Answer / what to notice

A spoon fits the soup clue; accept other objects that fit a child's clue.

A useful clue describes what an object does or what it is like.

Make it easier

Show two objects and let the child point to one.

Take it further

Give two clues before anyone guesses.

Another day, away from the screen

Describe three objects while tidying the room.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. One-sentence story circle

A little hint

Offer a choice: did it dance or visit a friend?

Answer / what to notice

Any connected, comfortable story is welcome; there is no fixed ending.

Taking turns makes room for both storytellers' ideas.

Make it easier

Let your child supply one word or animal sound.

Take it further

Recall the beginning, middle and ending together.

Another day, away from the screen

Retell the story to a toy at bedtime.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Animal sound detective

A little hint

Offer two names: cat or duck?

Answer / what to notice

“Meow” suggests a cat; accept the family’s usual sound words.

Different languages may write animal sounds differently while naming the same animal.

Make it easier

Make the sound and show the matching animal gesture.

Take it further

Give a feature clue without making its sound.

Another day, away from the screen

Listen for real bird sounds from a safe place together.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Where is Teddy?

A little hint

Model one position with your hand first.

Answer / what to notice

On means resting above the cushion; under means below it; beside means next to it.

Moving a real object gives each position word a visible example.

Make it easier

Practise only on and under.

Take it further

Try a two-part instruction: beside the cushion, then on it.

Another day, away from the screen

Use the same words when putting toys away.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. My day in three pictures

A little hint

Describe one real morning rather than an ideal routine.

Answer / what to notice

The order can differ between families; a clear explanation matters.

Sequence words help a listener follow events in order.

Make it easier

Use only two pictures.

Take it further

Add a fourth picture and explain where it belongs.

Another day, away from the screen

Draw an evening routine another day.